

Convair 240 Convair-Liner

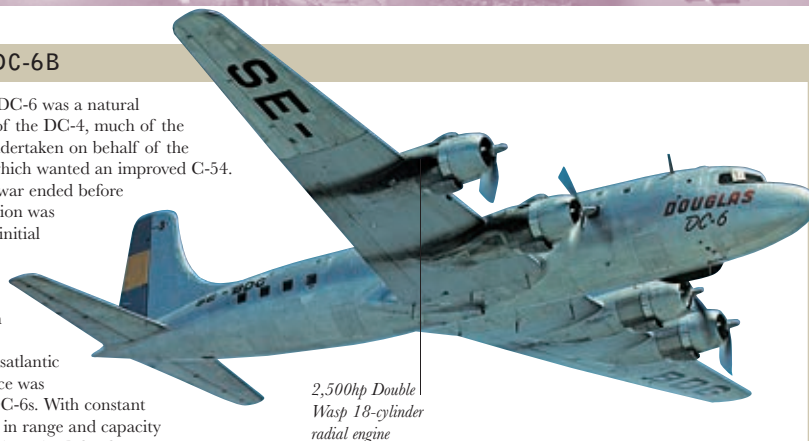
A direct competitor to the Martin 404, the Convair family of medium-sized airliners was far more successful. The first Convair Model 110 prototype flew in 1946, but could only carry 30 passengers. The enlarged 240, with more powerful engines, flew in March 1947. When production ended in 1958, a total of 571 Convair 240s had been manufactured, 176 as airliners and 395 as military C-131 and T-29 variants.



ENGINE 2 x 2,400hp P&W R-2800 Double Wasp 18 radial	
WINGSPAN 91ft 9in (28m)	LENGTH 74ft 8in (22.3m)
CRUISING SPEED 270mph (432kph)	
PASSENGERS 40	CREW 3-4

Douglas DC-6B

The Douglas DC-6 was a natural development of the DC-4, much of the work being undertaken on behalf of the US military, which wanted an improved C-54. Although the war ended before a military version was complete, the initial commercial version was immediately successful with 175 built. Pan Am's first transatlantic all-cargo service was operated by DC-6s. With constant improvements in range and capacity leading through to the DC-6C capable of carrying 107 passengers, over 700 DC-6s had been built when production closed in 1958. A few continued to fly as freighters in the 21st century.



ENGINE 4 x 2,500hp P&W R-2800 Double Wasp 18-cylinder radial	
WINGSPAN 117ft 6in (35.8m)	LENGTH 105ft 7in (32.2m)
CRUISING SPEED 307mph (494kph)	
PASSENGERS 54-102	CREW 3

Douglas DC-7C Seven Seas



The intense postwar competition between Douglas and Lockheed for the long-range airliner market produced some remarkable aircraft and engines. The DC-7 was the ultimate member of the four piston-engined family which began with the DC-4. Using energy efficient Wright Turbo Compound engines, the first DC-7 flew in May 1953. The production line closed in late 1958 after 338 had been built including 128 of the final variant, the superb DC-7C which BOAC flew as the Seven Seas.

ENGINE 4 x 3,400hp Wright R-3350 Turbo 18-cylinder radial	
WINGSPAN 127ft 6in (38.8m)	LENGTH 112ft 3in (34.2m)
CRUISING SPEED 360mph (580kph)	
PASSENGERS 65-105	CREW 7-8

Ilyushin Il-12 "Coach"

Designed to replace the Douglas DC-3 which had been built in the Soviet Union as the Lisunov Li-2, the Il-12 was produced in large numbers to rival the quantity of its famous predecessor. Conceived in 1943, the first flight of the unsuccessful prototype was on August 15, 1945. The redesigned aircraft, with the NATO reporting name of Coach, finally went into service with Aeroflot in August 1947 and was supplied in large numbers throughout the Warsaw Pact nations in both military and civil variants. Production ceased in 1949 in favor of the improved Il-14 (shown below).

ENGINE 2 x 1,650hp Shvetsov Ash-82FN 14-cylinder radial	
WINGSPAN 104ft (31.7m)	LENGTH 69ft 11in (21.3m)
CRUISING SPEED 217mph (350kph)	
PASSENGERS 27-32	CREW 4-5



Lockheed 1049G Super Constellation



One of the most graceful airliners of all time, the elegant L-49 was first conceived in 1939, only to be requisitioned for military use as the C-69. After the war, the 81-seat L-649 became the L-1049, after the fuselage was lengthened to accommodate up to 109 passengers.

ENGINE 4 x 3,250hp Wright R-3350 Turbo 18-cylinder radial	
WINGSPAN 123ft (37.5m)	LENGTH 113ft 7in (34.7m)
CRUISING SPEED 327mph (526kph)	
PASSENGERS 81-109	CREW 6

Martin Model 404 (4-0-4)

The Martin Model 202 was the first postwar, twin-engined airliner to fly. However, an accident in 1948, attributed to structural weakness of the wing, caused the temporary grounding of the type. An improved, pressurized Model 404 "Skyliner" overcame the accident's stigma to become a 1950s classic. Refinements included a longer fuselage and more powerful engines, making its cruising speed nearly 100mph (160kph) faster than the DC-3. A total of 103 were built between 1951 and 1953, mostly split between Eastern Airlines and Trans World Airlines (TWA).

ENGINE 2 x 2,400hp P&W R-2800 Double Wasp 18 radial	
WINGSPAN 93ft 3in (28.4m)	LENGTH 74ft 7in (22.7m)
CRUISING SPEED 286mph (460kph)	
PASSENGERS 34-42	CREW 3

